



COVER STORY

LEADERSHIP FOR THE 21ST CENTURY

RAVI S SAHANI



1

NETWORKING:

1. Godrej with Gore;
2. Aamir, Kapur, Katya and Wim Elfrink;
3. Akhtar, Jay Panda, Abdullah;
4. Celina and Ajay Bijli with Ashok Kapur;
5. Ambani and Purie with Advani;
6. Shashi Ruia, Asian Paints' Ashwin Dani



3

JATIN



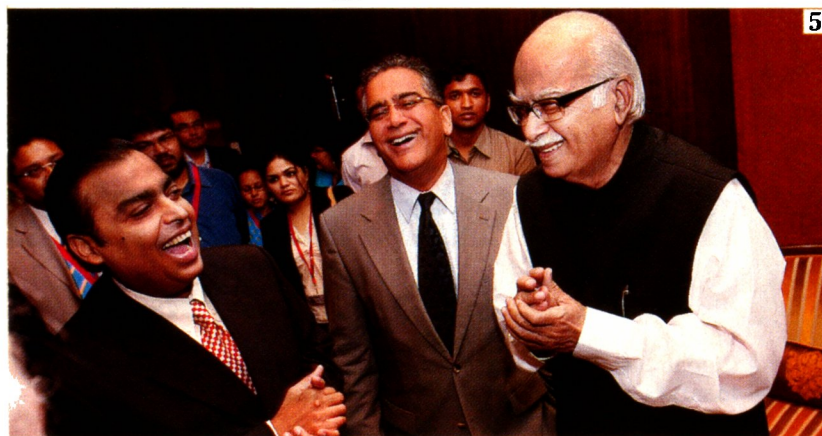
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HEMANT CHAWLA



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JATIN



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audience for his admission that he liked the good things of life (and Rajiv Gandhi's naturally red cheeks) was presented with endless questions on Kashmir. He had much to say to lyricist Javed Akhtar whose wife Shabana Azmi was a fellow motorcycle enthusiast during his days as Jammu and Kashmir chief minister. Abdullah's daughter, the long-legged Sara, divided her time equally between father and husband, Pilot, who spoke on the final day. Taking a biscuit during the coffee break, she said, "That's for all my hard work." One couple who really took their assignment seriously were Conclave regulars, former army chief General J.J. Singh and his wife Anupama. Having just been appointed as governor of Arunachal Pradesh, they arrived for the dinner dressed in state colours for the occasion.

In the morning, Ambani and Sunil Mittal of Bharti

Enterprises took turns to sit through each other's session before the former whisked him away in a private jet to Gujarat. Leader of the Opposition L.K. Advani, having just written his controversial new memoirs, stayed for lunch with wife Kamla and daughter Pratibha, as well as former deputy chairperson of the Rajya Sabha Najma Heptullah. But on day one, the 42nd President of the US Bill Clinton was the man of the hour, his live-via-satellite visage glowing with trademark exuberance, despite a heavy cold. He was barred from promoting his wife and Democratic candidate Hillary's cause but laughed when he was called a potential first spouse. "I'll do as I'm asked to," he said.

From the great and the good, from money to morality, from ideas to ideal chatter, it was enough evidence that even saving the world can be an exercise in finesse.